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Big Squeeze Soul Offers a Party You Can Actually Dance At

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I've often fallen for the nostalgia in family friends recounting disco nights of the past. The thing of anticipating who you'll bump into, half-remembered crushes, the relief of earworms blasted through sound systems...but most importantly was that tangible feeling of community through these conversations. Parties that bonded friendships many of my elders maintained to this day. Dancefloors were described as essential for breaking a long week of work ahead, and missing nights was almost treasonous.

I know much of this sentiment still remains with my agemates, but now more than ever it feels like conversations on going out start with, "I can't, I'm working," "the ticket is too much," or "I think we'll stay in," answers confronting the reality of our often monotonous (but necessary) wake-work routines. If you can afford entrance fees, a 4 a.m. night bus is less appealing when there's coffee to serve, hungover by 10 a.m. Our generation more than ever has comforts like digital conversations, food, love and entertainment achievable from our phones. In turn, is there less incentive to go out and participate in community?

Though surround-sound hosting sweaty bodies on dancefloors is fairly new in our timeline of human history, embodying rhythm in physical spaces remains paramount across cultures. When languages clash, movement can be trusted to translate whole conversations. How many times have we shared looks with strangers over a song, held hands with them, or passed a nod across the dancefloor, establishing a deep momentary understanding with someone we'll never see again? That's something invaluable.

Thinking about how important space and time to dance is, I wanted to speak to the guys behind one of London's well-loved dance nights, Big Squeeze Soul. With Tyler and Archie behind the decks, Big Squeeze offers "rare Soul, Latin, Brasilia, Jazz Funk, Boogie, Rare Groove n more (from the heart)." On their dancefloors you'll see, best friends in sync, soul heads spinning in baggies, and dancers with two left feet all invited to enjoy an expanse of music. Whether you're attending to grow your musical knowledge or to shake out a week of work, their vinyl-only sets reflect a curiosity, intentionally selected tracks with as much consideration for the space it's received in.

Before selling out the capacity of venues like the infamous Scala (ex-cinema, Kings Cross), Big Squeeze started after a night of sneaking friends into Tyler's flat for an organically formed boogie. With a broken toilet by morning, it didn't take long for the guys to move to a local venue's basement to accommodate their growing number of attendees. They now boast hosting dancefloors as far as Japan, and have earned ritualistic attendance across their home city. I was interested to hear what motivates and interests them to offer dance nights, putting people first.

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